

How to Spot a Phishing Email: The Basics

A free guide by Numenor Security to help you stay safe online

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a type of cyberattack where criminals pretend to be trusted organizations, like your bank, delivery service, or even a colleague, to trick you into sharing sensitive information or clicking malicious links.

These emails can look **incredibly realistic**. Even tech-savvy people get caught. The good news? With a few simple habits, you can spot most phishing attempts before they cause harm.

Red Flags to Watch For



Suspicious Sender Address

The email address doesn't quite match the real company. Look for misspellings like `support@micr0soft.com` instead of `microsoft.com`.



Urgent or Threatening Language

Phishers love pressure: "Your account will be locked in 24 hours!" or "Immediate action required!" Real companies rarely threaten you this way.



Links That Don't Match the Text

The link says "Log in to Chase Bank" but actually leads to `chase-login.ru`. Always hover before clicking.



Unexpected Attachments

You weren't expecting a file? Don't open it. Even PDFs and Word docs can contain malware.



Grammar or Formatting Errors

Poor spelling, weird spacing, or generic greetings like "Dear Customer" are common in phishing emails.

How to Verify an Email



Hover Over Links (Don't Click)

Move your mouse over any link. The real destination appears in the bottom-left corner of your screen.



Double-Check the Domain

Is it @amazon.com or @amaz0n-support.net? Only trust the official domain.



Contact the Company Directly

Go to their official website (type it in yourself) or call the number on your statement, not the one in the email.

Common Phishing Emails



Fake Password Reset

"We detected unusual activity. Click here to reset your password now."



Fake Delivery Update

"Your package is waiting at the depot. Pay \$2.99 to release it."



Fake Invoice or Payment Request

"Payment overdue. Avoid service interruption, pay now."

Quick Checklist Before You Click

- Do I know the sender personally?
- Was I expecting this email or attachment?
- Does the sender's email domain look correct?
- Is there urgent or threatening language?
- Did I hover over links to check the real URL?
- Are there spelling or grammar mistakes?

If you answer "No" to any of the first three, or "Yes" to the last three, pause and verify.

Stop Guessing - Start Protecting.

Sign up for Numenor Security's Anti-Phishing Service to automatically detect, block, and report phishing attempts before they reach your inbox.

www.numenorsecurity.com/signup